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| Job Title | **Senior Project Manager** |
| Location | Rio Cinema (some remote working possible) |
| Grade /Salary | £45,000 pro-rata |
| Contract: | Part time (3 days a week), 12 months |
| Specification agreed by | Rio Executive Director |
| Date of last update | October 2026 |
| Report to | Rio Executive Director |

This post is part of RIO FOREVER! which has been made possible with The National Lottery Heritage Fund, with thanks to National Lottery players.

**Scope:**

**RIO FOREVER is a year-long project, funded by the National Lottery Heritage Fund, marking 50 years of The Rio, Hackney's leading independent cinema, being run by and for its community. We have two aims:**

**1 to celebrate, record and share the Rio's heritage with the people who made it,** through community archiving sessions, and a wide-ranging participatory public consultation. We will also be working with a documentary filmmaker across the year.

**2 to secure the future of our Grade II listed building** by commissioning the architectural, condition, accessibility and sustainability work, and the business and fundraising planning, that will shape its next chapter.

As Senior Project Manager, you will lead RIO FOREVER day to day, from start to finish, owning the project plan, timeline and budget and commissioning and managing around ten professional briefs phased across the year.

The Rio is a small, busy team. Reporting to the Executive Director, you will work independently and use your initiative, keeping her informed through regular, concise updates and bringing key decisions and risks to her early. This is a hands-on role that calls for a high level of attention to detail alongside strategic thinking. It is for an experienced project manager who has led projects of comparable scale and complexity before and will bring that expertise from day one; it is not an entry-level or training role.

**Project Leadership** you will be responsible for delivering RIO FOREVER's approved purposes on time and to budget, maintaining the project plan, timeline and risk register, and making sure the different strands of work inform one another. You will report progress to the Executive Director and trustees and bring forward the decisions that need their input.

**Commissioning and Managing Professional Briefs** you will procure and manage the briefs for a phased programme of professional work: a building condition survey, an architectural brief, an accessibility audit,

a sustainability audit, a community consultation, and an independent evaluation. You will be the main point of contact for these consultants, managing their timelines, deliverables and fees. Other elements will include working with a fundraiser, business planner and documentary filmmaker.

**Budget and Funder Management** you will manage the project budget and be the day-to-day contact for the National Lottery Heritage Fund, preparing progress reports and payment requests and ensuring the project meets its grant conditions, including procurement and acknowledgement requirements.

**Event Planning** you will lead the planning of RIO FOREVER's public programme, including community archiving and consultation, taking each event from programme confirmation to handover to the Rio's Operations and Technical Managers for delivery. You will also be working with the Rio's Marketing team and an external PR agency to support outreach for the public-facing elements of the project.

**Evaluation and Documentation** you will work with the independent evaluator to meet our evaluation commitments, making sure data is gathered throughout the project, and will oversee the final project report for the National Lottery Heritage Fund, the Rio Board and team.

**You will represent the Rio at high-profile events and at meetings with community partners, the heritage, film and cinema sectors, and funders.**

- Deputising for the Executive Director in her absence in respect of the project.
- Any other duties and responsibilities within the range of the salary grade.

**How to apply:** please email Rosie, our ED, with your CV and a cover letter of no more than 2 sides of A4: rosie@riocinema.org.uk

**Deadline:** midday, Fri 04 December

We warmly welcome applicants from people of all backgrounds, and encourage applications from individuals who bring lived experiences and perspectives that reflect the vibrant, multicultural, and intersectional nature of our communities.

As a community-led organisation, we are particularly interested in applications from people with strong connections to the borough of Hackney.

| **Person Specification** |
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| **Education / qualifications**<br>• Degree-level education or equivalent professional experience<br>• Evidence of continuing professional development<br>• Desirable: a recognised project management qualification (e.g. PRINCE2 or APM) or a heritage or conservation-related qualification |

**Experience**

- Significant experience in a senior project management role, with a proven track record of independently leading more than one complex, multi-strand project of comparable scale from start to finish, on time and to budget
- Experience of writing briefs for, procuring and managing external consultants and professional services (for example architects, surveyors, evaluators or creative practitioners), and phasing their work to a timeline
- Experience of delivering externally funded projects, including managing grant budgets, reporting to funders and meeting grant conditions
- Experience of developing and delivering public events, engagement or consultation with and for communities in an arts, heritage or cultural organisation
- Experience of monitoring and evaluating programmes of work for funders
- Desirable: experience of delivering a National Lottery Heritage Fund project
- Desirable: experience of community archiving, oral history or participatory heritage work
- Desirable: experience of projects involving historic or listed buildings, or capital project development
- Desirable: good working knowledge of London's film and cinema culture and heritage
- Desirable: knowledge of, or a connection to, Hackney and its communities

**Skills, knowledge and attributes**

- Knowledge of the heritage sector and a genuine interest in community histories
- Highly organised - the ability to manage workflow and prioritise conflicting deadlines and to deal effectively with changing requirements
- A confident self-starter who takes the initiative, anticipates what needs doing and acts on it, making decisions and managing their own workload with minimal supervision
- Excellent written and verbal communication skills, including the ability to write clear briefs and concise progress reports
- Strong budget management and numeracy skills, with proven ability to identify savings and secure value for money
- Experience and knowledge of working with colleagues to implement audience development initiatives in order to diversify audiences and remove barriers to cultural participation
- Committed to working to ensure inclusivity in and access to the arts for all

- Excellent interpersonal skills including tact and diplomacy, with experience of adapting their communication style to suit different partners, stakeholders and colleagues
- Sound judgement in managing risk, and in knowing which issues to resolve independently and which to escalate to the Executive Director
- Proficient in Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Microsoft Outlook
- Meticulous attention to detail, including accurate record-keeping, budget tracking and reporting
- Comfortable working in a small, busy team, with a flexible, collaborative approach